



Sony HT-S2000 Soundbar

Perfect for home use, if you are ready for a small challenge

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Sony has been expanding its presence in the Indian audio space by launching products across budget and device categories. One of the latest products to come out of Sony's R&D labs is the Sony HT-S2000 Soundbar. Priced around ₹50,000 (₹42,900 on Amazon at the time of writing), the HT-S2000 soundbar falls into very tricky territory. Clearly, it does not fall into the upper echelons of the soundbar market, as we have seen much pricier and better-sounding systems. It is positioned, in my opinion, to fill the gap between the upper mid-range segment and the budget segment in Sony's portfolio in India. And when you are operating in this budget and target segment, providing a good mix of performance, features, and a great price-to-performance ratio is a must. The

3.1 channel soundbar showed up at the Digit Test Centre, and I spent some time playing with it as a standalone bar after pairing it with a separate subwoofer and two satellite speakers that Sony had sent over to the Test Centre. Here's what I found out –

Build and Design

The Sony HT-S2000 soundbar clearly borrows its design elements from its cousins, both above and below in terms of price. It carries a metallic front grill, painted in black, with the rest of the body being made of robust plastic, which does not feel like it would pick up many scratches and scuffs over long-term usage. The feet at the bottom of the soundbar also carry the quality of the rest of the soundbar and prevent any rattling or moving of the bar when it is pegged at max volume. I will speak about the loudness in detail later, but for now, just know that the bar on its own got pretty loud and, without proper support at the base, would have rattled off the surface it was placed on.

As for the design and overall look of the soundbar, the Sony design language and aesthetic sense carry through here

as well. The HT-S2000, in my opinion, would fit well in most of the interiors. The monochrome look of the bar, with branding only making a subtle appearance on the top part of the casing and the I/O ports being tucked at the back, allowing the cables to be routed around the back of the bar, increases its versatility in terms of just pure aesthetics.

If you are someone who would want to mount the bar on a wall, there are two keyholes provided by the brand with a set of support pegs, ensuring that you don't need to go through much hassle. The support around the holes is also enough to assure that the HT-S2000 wouldn't free itself of the clutches of the screws holding it in place.

Compatible satellite speakers and subwoofers

- Sony SA-SW5 subwoofer
- Sony SA-SW3 subwoofer
- Sony SA-RS3S wireless satellite speakers

Note - Sony had sent the Sony SA-SW3 subwoofer and the Sony SA-RS3S wireless satellite speakers to the Digit Test Centre along with the HT-S2000 soundbar. The same were used by the author during his time with the soundbar.

Features, Remote, and I/O

In terms of features, the Sony HT-S2000 brings to the table all the essentials that one would expect and need from a soundbar that they are spending half a lakh on. The first ones which I put to the test were the Vertical Surround Engine and S-Force Pro Front surround, which are supposed to mimic the presence of a vertical channel and channels on the side of the sound source, respectively. When using the soundbar in isolation, without the additional satellite speakers and subwoofer, the technology did register its presence. It is not as mind-blowing as the 360-degree surround sound that kicks in once you hook in the satellite speakers as well. However, for what it is, the feature works well.

Sony has also added their DSE Engine (Digital Sound Enhancement Engine)